



DEALER BEST PRACTICE SERIES

Effective Employee
Suggestion Programs

Application Maintenance Site Management **Component Rebuild** Component Life Management Safety MARC Management

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1.0 Introduction

Many dealers use an employee suggestion program as one source of ideas for improvements. Often, employee suggestion programs function more like a one-time event rather than a continuous, sustained process with a steady flow of suggestions and implemented improvements. Keeping the program active and maintaining employee participation and engagement is a key to successful results.

This best practice describes an Employee Suggestion Program implemented by Thompson Tractor Co.

2.0 Best Practice Description

An effective employee suggestion program must be well defined and have a formal process and structure including: responsibility, action, feedback, as well as reward and recognition.

Key fundamentals include:

- Ownership: One person with overall responsibility for the program.
- Employee training and communication on the program.
- A reward structure for an accepted idea. (Thompson pays \$200 to the idea submitter).
- A standard submission form.
- A review / screening process
- Feedback to submitters: Accepted (to be implemented) or not accepted and why.

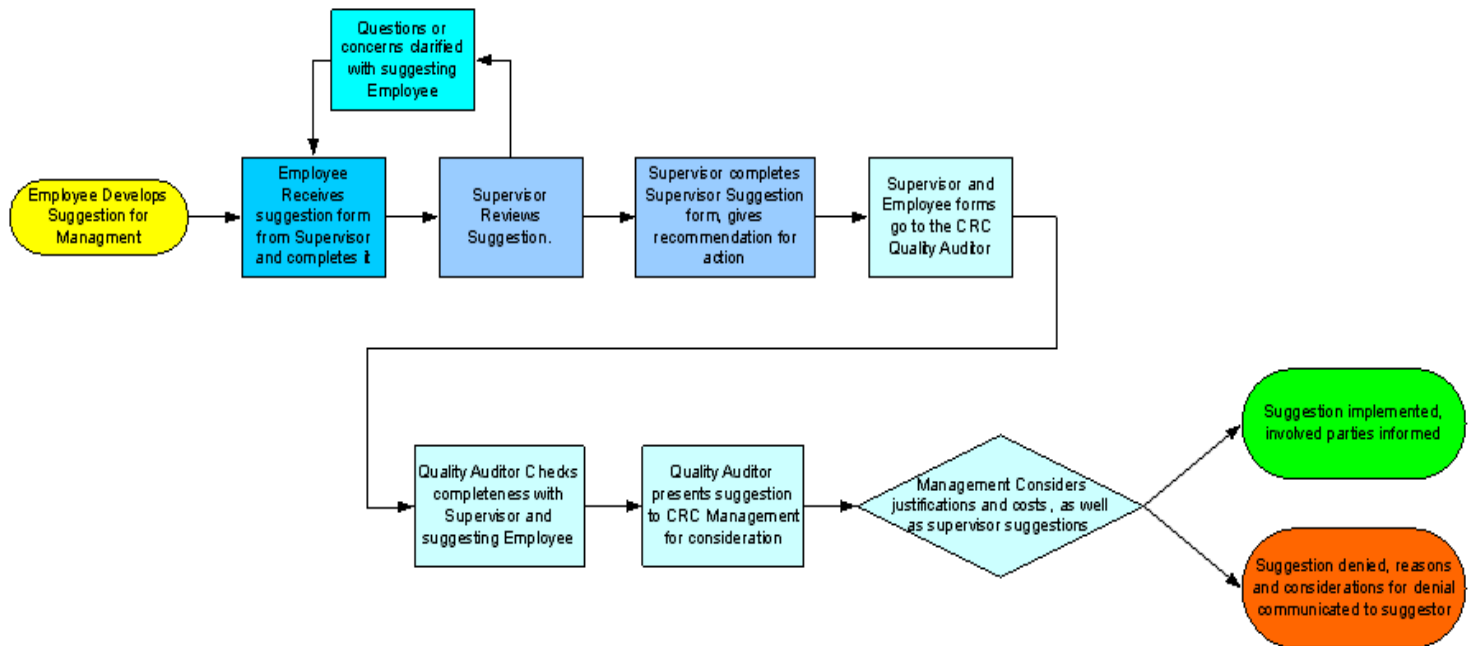
Simply creating a program is not in itself enough, employees must feel that they have a voice in change and that voice is valued and makes a difference.

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3.0 Implementation Steps

- Assign ownership and responsibility.
- Create the process:



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- Example Submission form

Date _____
 Employee Name _____ Employee # _____

Are there other employees involved in this project? _____
 If so WHO? _____

Explain the area the suggestion will apply.

Explain your suggestion (be thorough, attach extra pages if necessary).

Is the tool or process already in use in the area? (if yes, How long?)

How will your suggestion improve the efficiency and production or safety of the effected area?

Are all necessary drawings, including suggested dimensions, attached? _____

Are all necessary pictures, if any, attached? _____

Are statements from employees attached, if any? _____

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- Review / Approval Form - Supervisor

CRC DEPARTMENT SUGGESTION FORM
Filled out by the appropriate area supervisor

Name of employee submitting the suggestion: _____

Employee Number of employee submitting the suggestion: _____

Date received: _____

Note: if more than one employee is involved, please list all

Supervisor's name: _____

Pros:

Cons :

Additional comments:

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- Approval Form

CRC DEPARTMENT SUGGESTION FORM CHECK LIST
Filled out by the CRC Process and Quality Auditor

(fill in blanks with the date completed)

1. _____ All documentation received from supervisor.
2. _____ Documentation reviewed and discussed with the employee. (any extra documents should be requested at this time)
3. _____ Package prepared and distributed to the CRC Management Team
4. _____ Suggestion formally presented to the CRC Management Team for Consideration
5. _____ CRC Management Teams decision

Approved _____
Rejected _____
More Information Requested _____

6. _____ Approved, the CRC Manager has all necessary information to process payment. Action is taken by Area Supervisor to implement suggestion, if needed.
7. _____ Rejected, the CRC Process and Quality Auditor, meets with employee to explain the management team's decision.
8. _____ More information requested.
What information is needed?

9. _____ Once requested information is prepared; it is presented to the CRC Management Team for reconsideration. Return to step 4.

Process complete: Date _____, Signature _____
CRC Process and Quality Auditor

Note: all records will be kept by the CRC Process and Quality Auditor.

Approval Signatures
Area Supervisor: _____
CRC Process and Quality Auditor: _____
CRC Service Manager: _____
Birmingham Service Manager: _____
TTCO Vice President: _____

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4.0 Benefits

- Solution to problems.
- Improvements in safety, labor efficiency, and reduced costs.
- Employee engagement and recognition
- Improved employee moral.

5.0 Resources Required

Time to create, communicate, manage program.

6.0 Supporting Attachments / References

None at this time.

7.0 Related Best Practices

0207-4.5-1062 Labor Efficiency Lowers CRC Costs

8.0 Acknowledgements

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